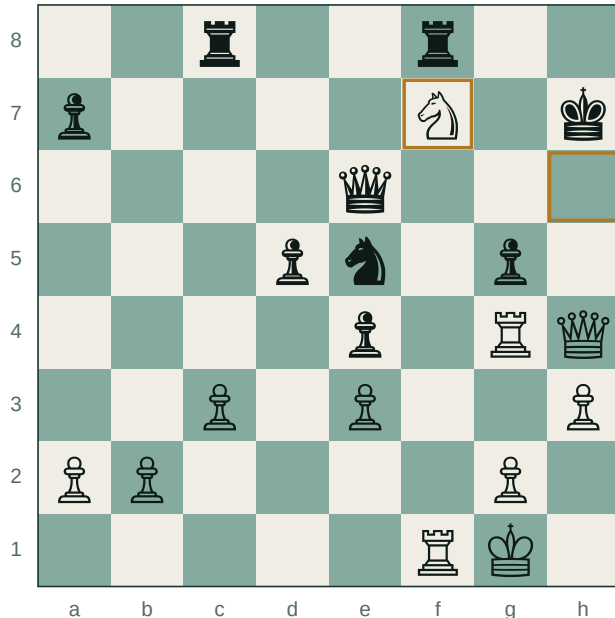


Kingside attacks: Black, move 27

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Nxf7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...gxh4 28. Ng5+ Kh6 29. Nxe6 Rxf1+ 30. Kxf1 Nxg4

27...gxh4 The pawn captures the queen on h4. Recorded reply: **28.Ng5+**.

28...Kh6 The king moves from h7 to h6. Recorded reply: **29.Nxe6**.

29...Rxf1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f1. Recorded reply: **30.Kxf1**.

30...Nxg4 The knight captures the rook on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.